

Daily Bible Note

Date: August 30, 2026

I. Today's Reading

NKJV: Ezekiel 48:15-22

15 "The five thousand cubits in width that remain, along the edge of the twenty-five thousand, shall be for general use by the city, for dwellings and common-land; and the city shall be in the center.

16 These shall be its measurements: the north side four thousand five hundred cubits, the south side four thousand five hundred, the east side four thousand five hundred, and the west side four thousand five hundred.

17 The common-land of the city shall be: to the north two hundred and fifty cubits, to the south two hundred and fifty, to the east two hundred and fifty, and to the west two hundred and fifty.

18 The rest of the length, alongside the district of the holy section, shall be ten thousand cubits to the east and ten thousand to the west. It shall be adjacent to the district of the holy section, and its produce shall be food for the workers of the city.

19 The workers of the city, from all the tribes of Israel, shall cultivate it.

20 The entire district shall be twenty-five thousand cubits by twenty-five thousand cubits, foursquare. You shall set apart the holy district with the property of the city.

21 "The rest shall belong to the prince, on one side and on the other of the holy district and of the city's property, next to the twenty-five thousand cubits of the holy district as far as the eastern border, and westward next to the twenty-five thousand as far as the western border, adjacent to the tribal portions; it shall belong to the prince. It shall be the holy district, and the sanctuary of the temple shall be in the center.

22 Moreover, apart from the possession of the Levites and the possession of the city which are in the midst of what belongs to the prince, the area between the border of Judah and the border of Benjamin shall belong to the prince.

II. Key Summary

- The five thousand cubits in width that remain are for general use by the city, for dwellings and common-land, with the city in the center; each side of the city measures four thousand five hundred cubits, with two hundred and fifty cubits of common-land on every side (15-17).
 - The rest of the length alongside the holy district runs ten thousand cubits east and ten thousand west, and its produce is food for the workers of the city; the workers of the city, from all the tribes of Israel, shall cultivate it (18-19).
 - The entire district set apart, together with the property of the city, is foursquare, twenty-five thousand cubits by twenty-five thousand; the land left on either side belongs to the prince, and the holy district with the sanctuary of the temple is in the center (20-22).
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III. Passage Analysis

The workers come from every tribe

The city itself is no longer, as of old, to belong to any particular tribe, but is to be situated on the common oblation, and its labourers are to be taken alike from all the tribes. Thus the old jealousies are to be extinguished, and in this, as in all other respects, each tribe is to be treated like every other. [1]

Verse 19 says the workers of the city come "from all the tribes of Israel," and verse 18 says the produce of that land is food for those workers. The workers come from every tribe, and not one tribe is skipped.

When all the measuring is done, the holy place is in the middle

The real point of all these descriptions is to give a central focus, and that focus is the holy district — more precisely, the holy place (the sanctuary) set at the very center of that central area. [2]

Verse 15 says "the city shall be in the center," and verse 21 says "the sanctuary of the temple shall be in the center." The previous section (48:1-14) measured out the land for the tribes and for the priests and Levites; this section (48:15-22) measures out the city and the prince's land — and when all the measuring is done, what keeps ending up in the

middle is the holy place.

IV. Reflection Question

What do you think God looks at first when He picks someone for His work?

In this passage the workers in the city come "from all the tribes of Israel" — God set it up that way when the land was divided; the door into Christ's kingdom stands open to all who believe, and whoever will may come freely.

References

[1] BibleHub.com, Ellicott's Commentary for English Readers (Ezekiel 48:19),
<https://www.biblehub.com/commentaries/ezekiel/48-19.htm>

[2] Chinese Christian Bible Study Website, Tang Yau-Chi, Tien Dao Bible Commentary —
Ezekiel (translated from Chinese),
<https://www.ccbiblestudy.org/Old%20Testament/26Ezek/26GT48.htm>